CRC Website — Phase 1 Revision Notes

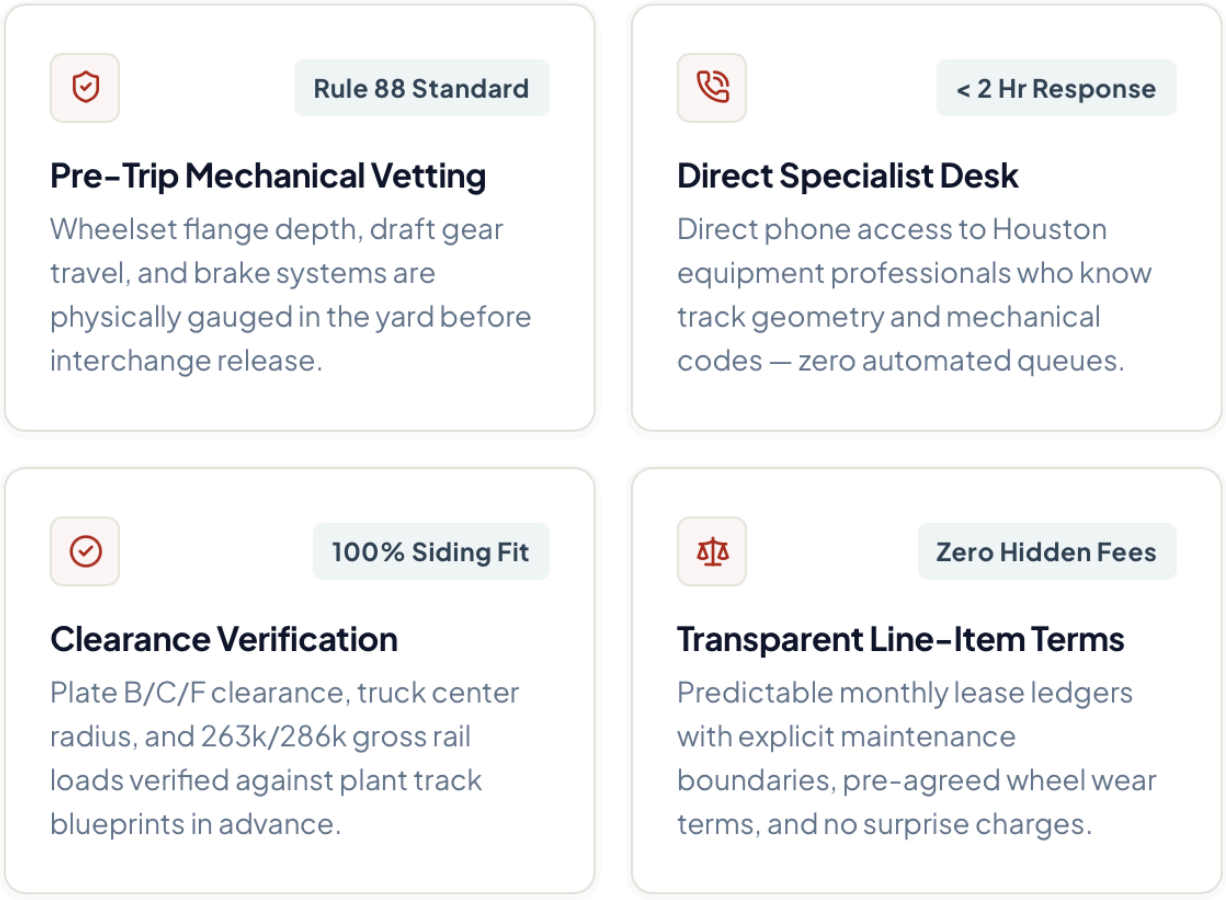
Nov 3, 2026 · @Sam Lowe

Harshit, these notes cover how the site looks and reads. Placeholder copy, contact details, legal pages, and the backend are being handled separately, so they're not covered here. Each screenshot below has its own notes, followed by a few site-wide design points and two new feature ideas.

Top changes

1. **Replace the cards with text rows only where flagged:** the service feature cards (section 1) and the value cards (section 6). Cards stay everywhere else.
2. **Redesign the value cards** from my sketch: large lead icon, title, tightened text, a stat line (section 6).
3. **Rework the hero badges** as a spec strip, or remove them (section 4).
4. **Make boxcar sizes selectable** and carry the choice straight into the cost estimator. The layout stays as it is (section 3).
5. **Connect the estimator to the rest of the site,** so every selection and inquiry carries straight into the cost tool (section 7).
6. **Idea for later, not part of this build:** a 3D railcar viewer.
7. **New FAQ entry** for shippers who don't have a rail siding yet.

1. Service feature cards



Replace the card grid with text rows (see Text rows instead of cards). Four boxed cards in a 2×2 grid look generic.

- One row per point: large icon on the left, title and one line of text on the right, dashed rules between rows.
- Remove the pill badges.

2. Boxcar and covered hopper cards



Boxcars

Enclosed freight railcars engineered to protect manufactured, palletized, paper, and food products from weather.

LENGTHS	PAYLOAD	ACCESS
50' & 60'	70T – 100T	Plug / Sliding

Technical Specs › Request Quote



Covered Hoppers

Weather-sealed hopper railcars engineered for gravity, pneumatic, or pressure differential discharge of dry bulk commodities.

VOLUME	DISCHARGE	HATCHES
3,230–6,541 cu ft	Gravity & PD	Trough & Round

Technical Specs › Request Quote

The specs block and layout work well.

- **Change the button label from "Request Quote" to "Request Sourcing"** and have it open the request form with the car type already filled in.

3. Boxcar sizes and configurations

Sizes & Configs (6) Overview & Profile Commodities (5)

Standard Configurations & Capacities 6 Options

50-ft Standard Standard cubic capacity for packaged freight and general manufacturing.	Inquire Size ›
50-ft High-Cube Added vertical clearance for higher-volume pallet stacking.	Inquire Size ›
60-ft Standard Extended length for higher-density pallet loading and automotive parts.	Inquire Size ›
60-ft High-Cube Maximum enclosed volume for light-to-medium density goods and paper rolls.	Inquire Size ›
Insulated Thermal insulation to prevent extreme temperature swings during transit.	Inquire Size ›
Refrigerated Mechanical refrigeration units for perishable and frozen food products.	Inquire Size ›

Allocation & Mechanical Delivery
Equipment specifications and lease terms vary by specific car series. Inquire with CRC for current sourcing options. Request Boxcars Sourcing →

Leave this section as it is. The only change is the hand-off into the cost estimator:

- **Make each size selectable.** Clicking a row or its "Inquire Size" link opens the cost estimator with the car type and size already filled in. Step 01 shows Boxcars and step 02 shows the chosen size, for example `/cost-estimator?category=boxcars&size=50-ft-standard`.
- **Do the same for every car type's size list** in the catalog, so a visitor can browse, pick, and land in the estimator already set up.

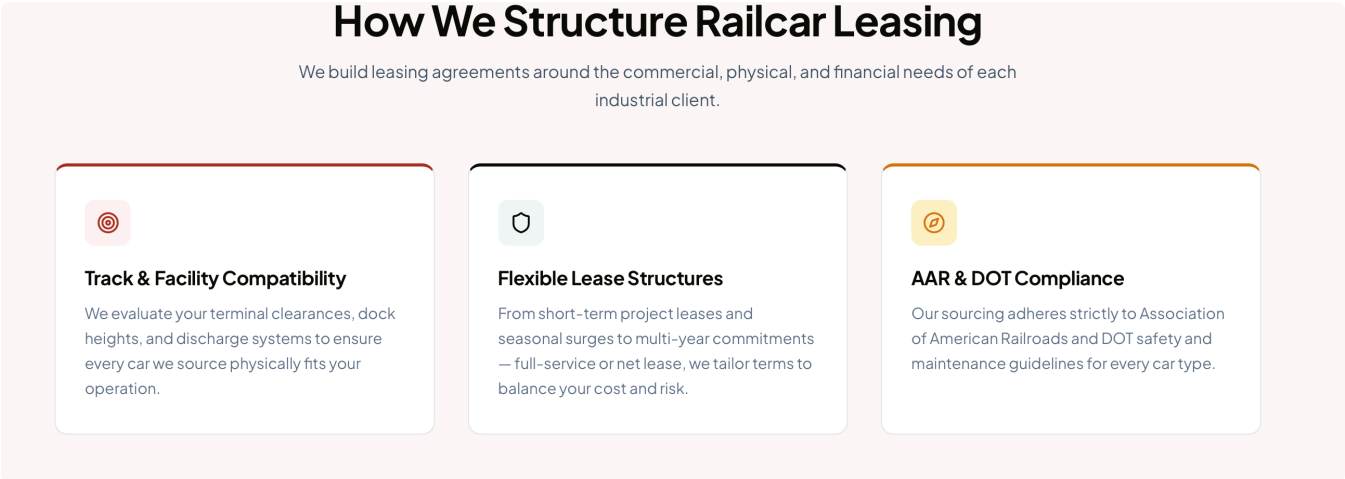
4. Hero badges



The badges as they are don't work: three colored dots and loose text over the photo look like leftover UI. Two options:

- **Option A (recommended): a spec strip.** A thin bar along the bottom edge of the hero with three label/value pairs separated by thin vertical rules. For example: CAR TYPES · 7 | LEASE TERMS · Full-service & net | COVERAGE · North America. It reads like a data plate on a railcar, which fits the subject.
- **Option B: remove them.** Fold one line into the hero subhead ("Seven car types, full-service or net lease") and let the headline and CTAs carry the hero.

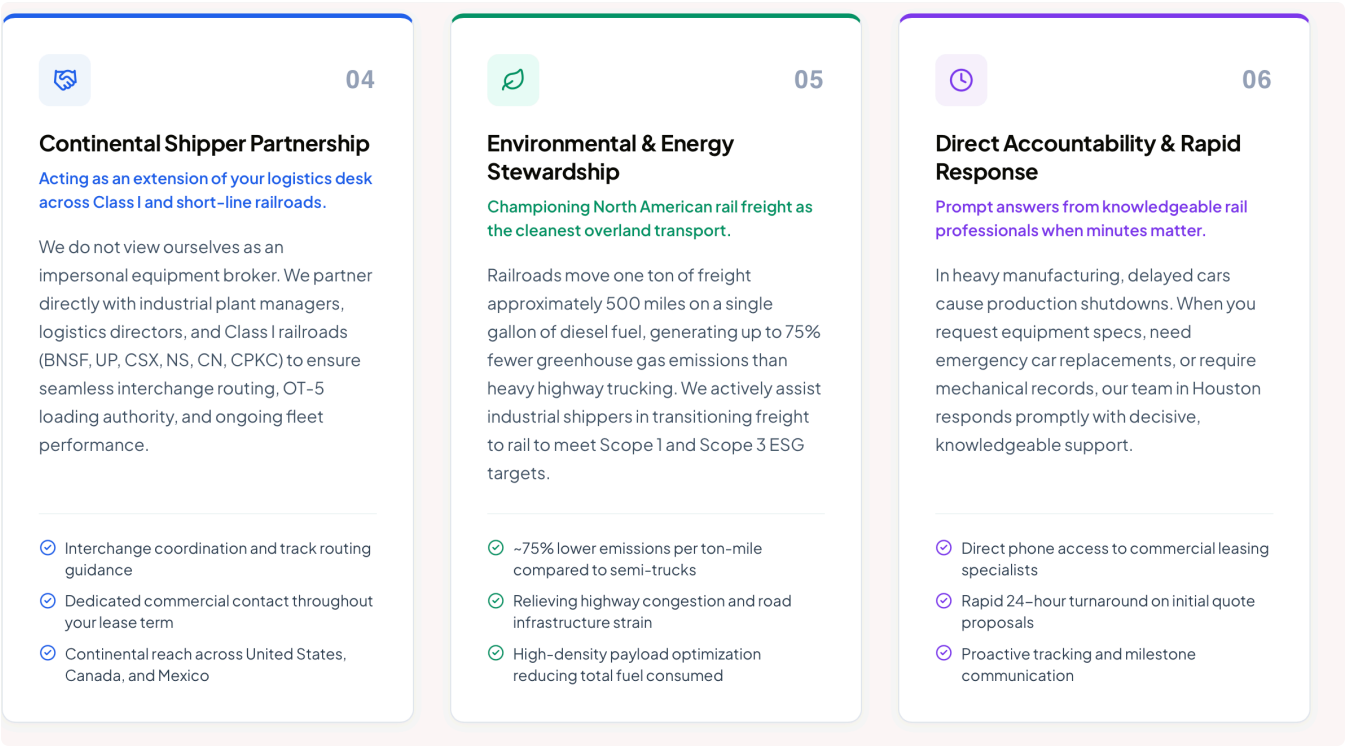
5. How We Structure Railcar Leasing (About page)

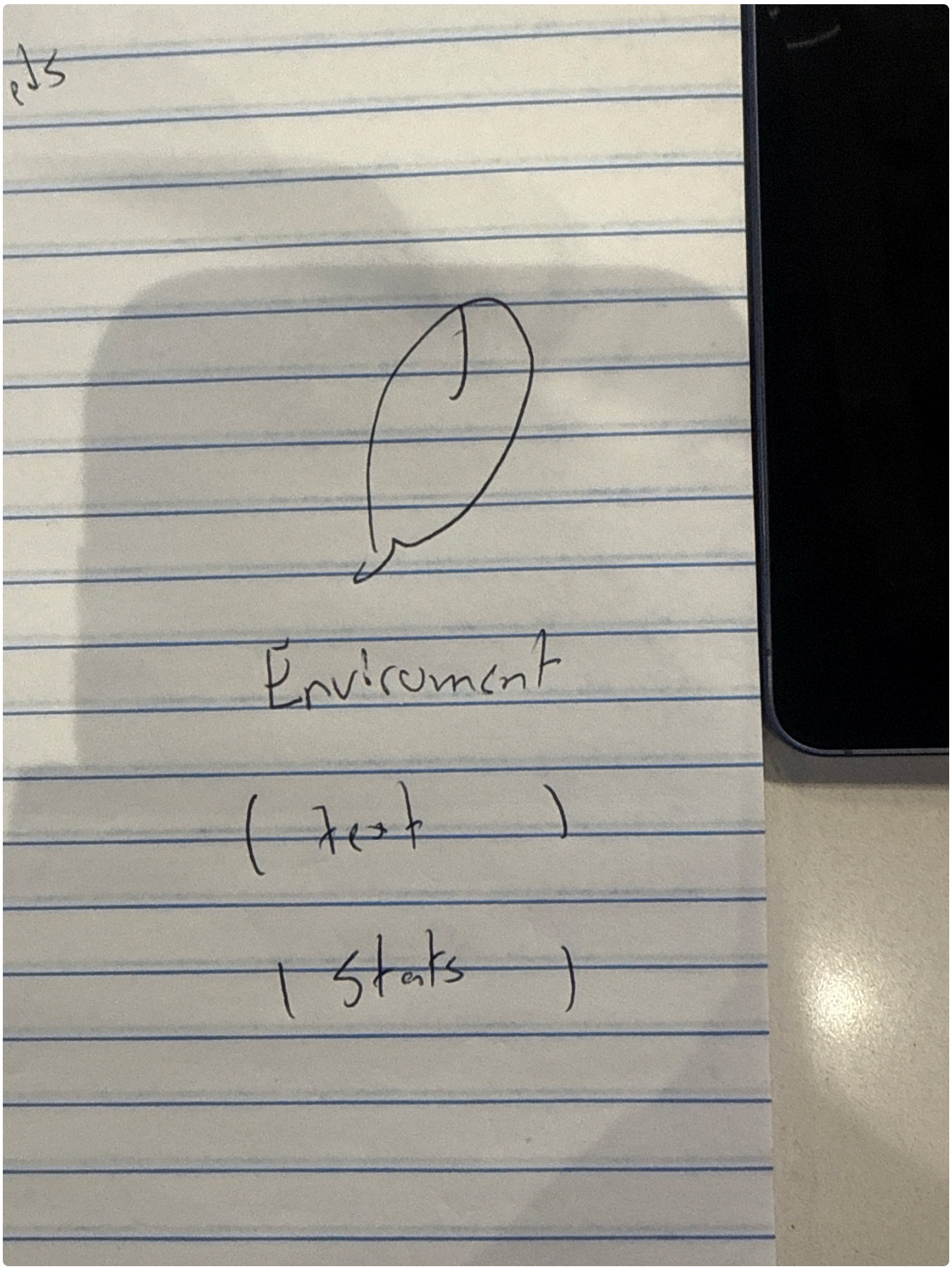


- **Keep the card layout here.**

- **Use one accent color** for the top borders instead of red, black, and orange.
- **Use the same large icon treatment** as the value cards, with no tinted box.

6. Values cards: partnership, environmental, response




pJs
Enviroment
(Text)
(Stats)

Use my sketch as the layout. Keep the current text, but tighten each value around its numbers and why they matter. No card box.

Layout (top to bottom, centered)

1. **A large icon** as the lead: about 64–80 px, brand red line icon, no box or pill behind it.
2. **A short title,** one or two words (for example "Environment").
3. **Text:** the existing description, cut to two or three lines. Lead with why it matters to the shipper.
4. **A stat line:** two or three figures separated by thin dividers, set larger and bolder than the text so they're the first thing read after the title.

Remove the colored top borders, the colored subheads (blue, green, purple), and the checkmark bullet lists. The stat line replaces the bullets.

Example: 05 Environment

- **Text:** Moving freight from highway to rail cuts fuel use and emissions on every load, which helps shippers meet their sustainability targets.
- **Stats:** ~500 miles per ton per gallon | Up to 75% fewer emissions than trucks | 3–4 trucks off the road per car

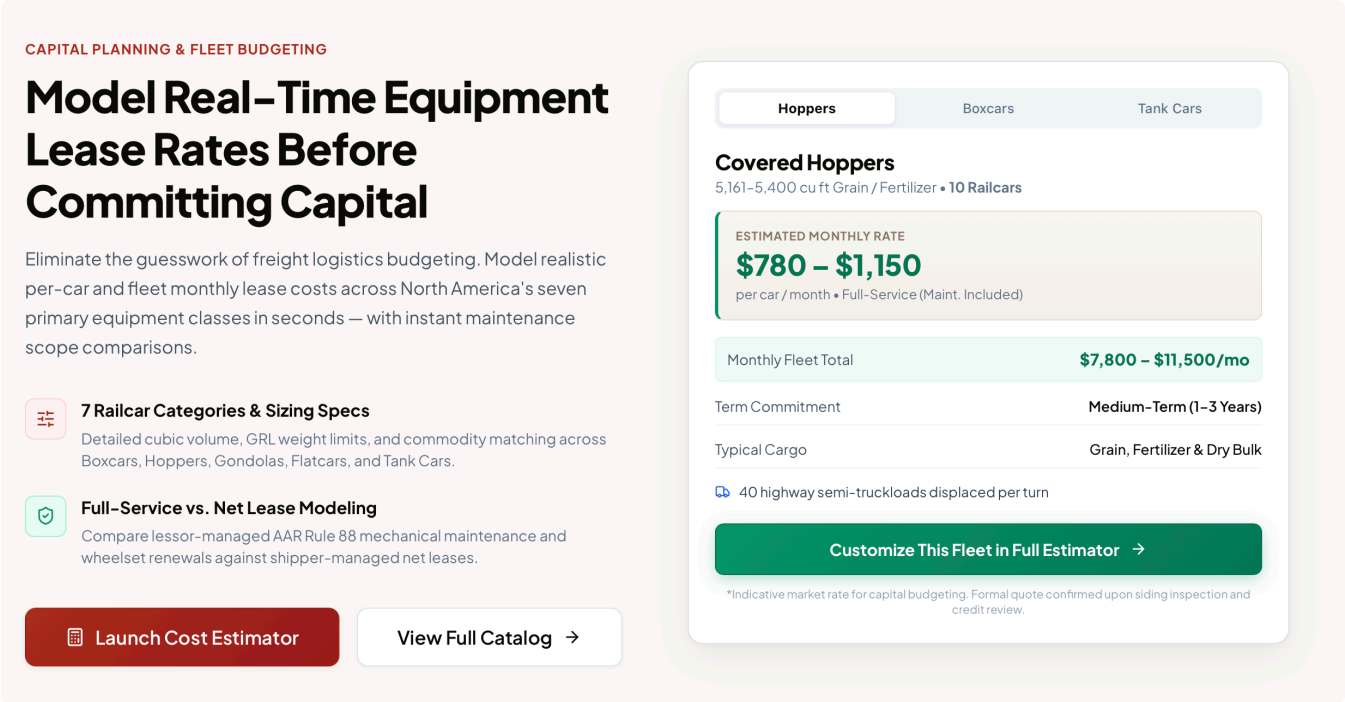
Stat lines for all six, taken from the site's current copy:

#	Title	Stat line
01	Safety	AAR Rule 88 · FRA 49 CFR · Pre-trip inspection
02	Clear Deals	Line-item maintenance scope · No hidden per-diem fees
03	Flexibility	3–12 mo · 1–3 yr · 3–5+ yr terms
04	Partnership	6 Class I railroads · US, Canada & Mexico
05	Environment	~500 mi per ton per gallon · Up to 75% fewer emissions · 3–4 trucks per car
06	Response	24-hour quote turnaround · Direct line to a specialist

Keep the 3 × 2 grid, but make it flow:

- **No card boxes:** each value sits on the page background. Separate them with space, plus thin vertical rules between columns and one horizontal rule between the two rows.
- **The same height and alignment for all six:** icons on one line, titles on one line, stat lines on one line. That way the grid reads straight across.
- **Even rhythm:** the same spacing between icon, title, text, and stats in every value. Give the grid more space around it than it has now.
- **A soft entrance:** fade each value up slightly as it scrolls into view, one after another (01 to 06). Skip it for visitors who have reduced motion turned on.
- **Phones:** two columns, then one on the smallest screens, keeping the same order.

7. Cost estimator preview



The estimator itself is staying as it is. The note here is about connecting it to the rest of the site, so whatever a visitor picks anywhere carries into the full cost tool without being re-entered.

- **From this preview card:** when a visitor clicks "Customize This Fleet in Full Estimator," pass the car type, size, car count, and term over, not just the category. The link already passes `?category=covered-hoppers`; extend it, for example `?category=covered-hoppers&size=5161-5400&qty=10&term=medium`.

- **From "Inquire Size" and "Request Sourcing":** open the estimator, or the request form, with that car type and size already selected.
- **From the estimator to the request form:** attach the estimate (car, size, count, term, range) to the request, so I see exactly what they priced.



What makes the reference work:

- **Two columns per row:** a small label on the left (date, number, or icon) and a large title with one or two lines of body text on the right.
- **Thin dashed rules between rows** instead of borders around each item.
- **A big type contrast:** the titles are large, and the body text is small and muted.
- **No boxes, fills, or shadows.** The rows sit directly on the page background.
- **A subtle scroll effect:** rows brighten as they reach the middle of the screen and dim as they leave.

Text rows instead of cards (flagged sections only)

I want this layout in the two places I flagged, not across the whole site. Cards still work for the equipment catalog, the estimator, and the other sections.

Where to use it:

Section	Left column	Right column
Company values 01–06 (section 6)	Stacked and centered instead (see the section 6 sketch):	large icon, title, text, stat line
The four service points (section 1)	Large icon	Title and one line of text. Replaces the card grid.

Design rules for every section:

- One accent color (the brand red) plus neutrals. No blue, green, purple, or orange accents.
- The same icon treatment everywhere: line icons, large, in the accent color, with no tinted box behind them.
- Tighter corners (3–4 px) on what stays boxed: buttons, inputs, and the estimator panels.

Idea for later: 3D railcar viewer

Not part of this build; noting it for the future.

- **The idea:** a railcar version of Koenigsegg's online configurator. One car is featured at a time in a studio-lit 3D scene. Visitors pick any of the seven car types, rotate and zoom it, then send that car to the cost estimator.

- **Where it could go:** the homepage, a "View in 3D" link in the catalog, and step 02 of the estimator.
- **Feasibility:** it works in a browser today (three.js or Google's model-viewer, no plugins). The main effort and cost would be seven realistic, textured railcar models, one per car type, bought or commissioned.

New FAQ entry: shippers without a rail siding

A lot of first-time rail shippers will reach the site without track of their own. Add an FAQ entry for them, possibly with a short callout near the quote form:

"I don't have a rail siding. Can I still use railcars?" Yes. Three common ways in:

- **Transload:** ship through a nearby transload facility, where cargo moves between truck and railcar.
- **Team track:** load at a railroad-owned public track near you.
- **Your own track:** reactivate dormant track on your property, or add a new spur. We can help you find rail-compatible sites, too.

End the entry with a "Tell us your location" button that opens the request form.